

Commissioner's Message

In 2024, CNIPA thoroughly implemented the spirit of President Xi Jinping's important instructions on IP and strived to build world-class IP governance systems, institutional rules, cultural environment and talent teams. CNIPA consistently promoted high-quality creation, high-efficiency utilization, high-standard protection, high-quality services and high-level international cooperation in IP field to better support and guarantee high-level innovation and high-quality development and effectively serve modernization with Chinese characteristics. In the Global Innovation Index issued by the World IP Organization (WIPO) in 2024, China ranked 11th and, for two consecutive years, led with the most clusters (26) in the world's "Top 100 Science and Technology Clusters".

Over the past year, CNIPA continued to strengthen high-quality IP creation and made efforts to provide high-quality services. The total number of domestic valid invention patents in China reached 4.756 million, making China the world's first country with more than 4 million domestic valid invention patents. China ranked first globally in both PCT international patent and Hague international design applications and ranked third steadily in the world in the number of applications for Madrid trademark international registration. China led the world in the number of invention patents for the "New Trio", namely electric vehicles, lithium-ion batteries, and solar cells. The average pendency for the examination of invention patent applications was reduced to 15.5 months and the average pendency for the examination of trademark registration applications was maintained at 4 months, both reaching the fastest

level internationally under the equivalent examination system. Substantial progress was made in the application of multimodal large-model technology in patent examination. The standards and levels of IP public services were continuously optimized, and the scale and scope of open sharing of IP data were constantly expanded.

Over the past year, CNIPA continued to promote high-efficiency IP utilization to empower the development of new quality productive forces. The special action for patent commercialization and utilization was comprehensively promoted, with the number of patent transfer and licensing recordings throughout the year reaching 613 thousand, and the total import and export volume of IP royalties reaching 398.71 billion RMB. According to a report by WIPO, among the top 5 thousand brands worldwide, the brand value of Chinese brands amounted to 1.76 trillion USD in total, ranking second globally. The direct output value of geographical indication products exceeded 960 billion RMB, and the trademark brand building and the geographical indication industry flourished.

Over the past year, CNIPA continued to strengthen the high-standard IP protection to stimulate the enthusiasm of innovators. The newly amended *Implementing Regulations of the Patent Law* and *Patent Examination Guidelines* were officially implemented, amendments to the *Trademark Law* and the *Regulations on the Protection of Layout-Designs of Integrated Circuits* were speeded up, and the *Guide for Patent Applications for Artificial Intelligence-Related*

Inventions and the Implementation Plan for the Unified Recognition System of Geographical Indications were issued. The pilot project for IP protection of data was further promoted. The construction of the second batch of national IP protection highlands was carried out at a high standard, with 124 national IP protection centers and fast-track IPR enforcement centers built. The social satisfaction rating on IP protection reached 82.36, hitting a record high.

Over the past year, CNIPA continued to advance high-level international cooperation on IP to contribute Chinese wisdom and solutions to creating an international environment conducive to innovation and development. Support was provided for hosting the 2024 International Association for the Protection of IP (AIPPI) World Congress, and President Xi Jinping sent a congratulatory letter to the congress. The 3rd Belt and Road High-Level Conference on IP was held on a grand scale, and Vice Premier Ding Xuexiang met with high-level guests attending the conference to promote the quality improvement and upgrading of IP Cooperation along the Belt and Road. CNIPA constructively promoted the conclusion of the *WIPO Treaty on Intellectual Property, Genetic Resources and Associated Traditional Knowledge* and the *Riyadh Design Law Treaty*. It deeply participated in the IP5, China-Japan-ROK, China-ASEAN, China-Central Asia, China-Africa and other institutional IP cooperation mechanisms, and promoted the upgrading and expansion of the BRICS cooperation on IP. The *Agreement between the Government of the People's Republic of China and the European Union on Cooperation on and Protection of*

Geographical Indications was further implemented, and mutual recognition and protection of the second batch of GI products by China and the EU were accelerated. The Patent Prosecution Highway (PPH) cooperation network covering 84 countries and regions was constantly expanded and optimized.

The year 2025 marks the conclusion of China's the 14th Five-Year Plan. It is also a crucial year for formulating the 15th Five-Year Plan. CNIPA will continue to comprehensively strengthen the chain of IP creation, utilization, protection, management, service and international cooperation, and further deepen the friendly cooperation with IP offices of other countries and regions worldwide. CNIPA is willing to work with all parties to jointly create an open, fair, just and non-discriminatory global innovation environment, and make joint efforts to establish a global IP governance pattern featuring extensive consultation, joint contribution and shared benefits to serve the people of all countries.



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